



A WORLD IN CONFLICT

1880–1945

Designers and manufacturers in Europe and North America continued to develop new and ever more efficient military firearms. The 1880s and 1890s saw the arrival of the modern machine-gun, smokeless powder, the first self-loading military rifle, self-loading pistols, and artillery of the types that would be responsible for the carnage of World War I. In the years between the world wars, and during World War II, many new types of rapid-fire, higher-velocity, and longer-range firearms were created and adopted into service throughout the Western world.